Triple hooks: relevance, curiosity and an earned payoff

Researched 2026-11-07.

Strengths and best use

The triple-hook framework gives writers a repeatable way to establish a topic, build curiosity, and reveal a surprising direction. Its main strength is forcing the opening to make a clear promise that the body can pay off. The Muse dossier records the creator's presentation and distinguishes the short reel from its longer, gated materials.

Current checks

The inspected evidence does not establish a universal three-second threshold or guaranteed performance. Retention metrics have definitions that vary by surface and format. YouTube's guidance explains how to inspect where viewers remain or leave, which is a better starting point for a controlled comparison. Audience retention (https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/9314415?hl=en)

Write and compare

1. State the audience, concrete topic, and supported payoff in plain language.
2. Write three openings using relevance, an unanswered question, or a surprising observation. Use only facts the video can substantiate.
3. Align spoken words, visual evidence, overlay text, and sound. Remove any implication that the body cannot satisfy.
4. Keep the video's body and distribution conditions as similar as practicable. Record early retention, completion, qualified next actions, and sample size.
5. Look for a repeated pattern across several comparable videos. A single viral example supplies a hypothesis for the next test.

Reusable prompt

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Write three clear openings for this audience and supported payoff. Explain the curiosity each creates and where the body resolves it. Align speech, visual, text, and sound. Audit every statistic and implied promise, then provide a retention comparison plan with a stated observation window.
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Project idea

Build a hook-to-payoff worksheet and a cohort comparison report. Start with your own scripts and leave outcome cells empty until observed.

Original sources

- https://www.instagram.com/reel/De_5mQ0R8PE/